

Snippets

Now, wireless sensors that can work under water

An underwater wireless sensor is being developed by researchers of University of Buffalo, which makes use of the TCP/IP for transmitting data over the Internet. As cited on crazyengineers.com, making this information available to anyone with a smartphone or computer, especially when a tsunami or other type of disaster occurs, could help save lives and it could be used to even monitor fish and marine mammals, and find out how to best protect them from shipping traffic and other dangers.

A Google Glass alternative

An unfunded startup firm, called LaForge Optical, has reportedly created an alternative to the Google Glass, which is priced at \$200. According to a Venture Beat report, the firm says their device is much more immersive than the Google Glass and is much less geeky. The device reportedly allows for prescription lenses and can perform tasks like recording videos, taking pictures, sharing on Facebook and other social networks and navigation. The device uses a user's smartphone to connect to the cloud, but unlike the Google Glass, this one's intelligence also resides within an app on the smartphone.

Now, X-ray vision for drivers imminent

Drivers may soon be equipped with X-ray vision, which lets them see through traffic in front of them. According to reports, a University of Porto research team has developed technology, which gives drivers such capabilities. The system is called STS and it helps a driver to decide whether it is a good idea to overtake vehicles like a truck or other heavy vehicle. It will be of use to the fast-growing augmented reality (AR) technology. According to reports, the researchers have said that they got good results, especially after putting an 801.11p wireless communication protocol.

around the \$500,000 and above mark. The new open source printer, on the other hand, is meant to be used at home and much less expensive.

Now Wi-Fi through light bulbs

Chinese researchers have successfully transmitted wireless signals through light bulbs. According to reports, the researchers hypothesised that four computers under a light bulb can use light as a carrier and connect to the Internet.

Further, Chi Nan, an IT professor from the Shanghai-based Fudan University, said that since microchips are embedded in a light bulb, they can facilitate transfer of data at speeds of about 150 mbps. The technology is known as Li-Fi technology and is much cheaper than the existing Wi-Fi Internet technology.

Further, Chi reportedly said that in order to boost signals for cell phones, there are millions of base stations around the world. But, a major part of

their energy is taken up by their cooling systems and that a mere five per cent of the total energy is utilised. She agreed though that Li-Fi technology needs to go a long way and is currently impractical and signals would subside the minute the light goes out or is blocked. The technology was named by Haral Hass from the Edinburgh University and stands for Light Fidelity. If perfected, it has a lot of social implications and possibilities.

A cost-effective battery that can store solar power in works

Imagine a battery that could store solar power! Well, a battery of this kind is being worked upon by the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT), Madras. What is more interesting is that it will be a cost-effective battery technology, which will be capable of storing large quantity of electricity.

IIT-M director Prof. Bhaskar Ramamurthi told *Deccan Chronicle* that

several faculty at the institute had started their research on optimisation of electricity and appropriate battery technology. "We are working on lower life-cycle cost. We are looking at bulkier, non-portable, batteries, which would be used for fixed use. Centre for Decentralised Photovoltaic Systems in our institute is working on how to handle problem of load shedding and harness solar power locally," he added.

Prof. Ramamurthi shared that India is a country that gets solar power for over 300 days in a year from 9 am to 4 pm with variations. However, owing to the solar tech that the country has at present, there is a mismatch in production and storage. He further added that a person had to spend ₹ 14 to store one unit of power in the battery.

A headset that can monitor your heart rate

A Bluetooth audio headset that can capture its wearer's heart rate when he or she is listening to music has been developed by the companies, Valencell and iRiver Ltd.

As stated on crazyengineers.com, the ON Headset is the first in its rank to be powered by Valencell's PerformTek Precision Biometrics sensor technology. With the aid of these sensors, the iRiver ON earphones can monitor with precision more number of real-time physiological data than any fitness monitor. The headset is not only good for monitoring one's real-time heart rate but will also be able to keep a track of one's physical location and workout data.

The iRiver ON headset has a simple design offering all the biometric feedback along with iRiver's legendary listening experiences, that bring easy music and call controls to boot. The headset will also be accompanied with its own complementary fitness application for iOS and Android smartphones. The data which is monitored will be shown on the user's paired mobile device through this accompanying app, used for tracking progress and creating a personalised fitness training program.

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